



PVE NW Process for Block Captain Application, Interview and Welcome

Revision 7, 10/27/21

Process Steps from Resident Interest through Welcome

1. Interested Resident:

- a. Complete the Block Captain application provided by AC or found on pvenw.org
 - i. Form is in Box folder AC Toolkit > AC Tools for Block Captain Selection
- b. Send in application to Area Coordinator

2. AC Prep for Interview:

Do some quick background research to get to know the applicant. Ask PVE NW Board members if they know the applicant. It is important to make sure that our volunteers have an appropriate motivation and have been a positive factor in our community.

- a. Review the BC Application
- b. Verify that you don't already have BC coverage for the area.
 - i. If you do, you may want to contact the other BC and see if they would like a partner.
 - ii. If you can't take on a BC for the location, see if the person would like to get involved in another way
- c. Check **NW Membership** file to verify BC applicant info is up-to-date and membership is current
- d. Check **nextdoor.com** to see type of engagement the interviewee has engaged in. Are they friendly and kind?
- e. Check with **NW Board Members** who might know the person and see if there are any concerns.
- f. Contact applicant to set up an introductory call OR email to indicate that there is not an opening or there is not a good fit.
 - i. Review email with president prior to sending "decline" email.
 - ii. See sample email noted below.

3. AC Interview with BC Applicant:

An interview provides an opportunity to get to know a prospective Block Captain and ensure that they are a good fit for the role and the organization. Have a call or meet them at their home. Have your goals be to help the applicant understand the commitment and responsibility, answer their questions and determine if they are a good candidate to represent NW to their neighbors.

- a. During the call, leverage the **BC Interview Guide** (Appendix 1, below), to help get to know the BC and determine if they would be a good representative of PVE NW
 - i. Ask questions (see the **BC Interview Guide** below for some ideas)
 - ii. Provide information/expectations
 - iii. Answer their questions
 - iv. Take notes on what additional info they may need and you need to find from President or Communications Chair

- v. Find out what they would define as their Block. Get specific about the addresses or boundaries so you can ensure that you have coverage, understand how much they would like to take on and verify that you don't have duplication coverage by mistake.
 - vi. Provide decision or let them know you will get back with them (especially if you have concerns)
 - vii. Talk about next steps
- 4. **Contact President** (*NEW in Revision 7*)
 - a. As a final check before deciding, contact the President and let them know how your interview went and get any final questions or concerns (that you or the candidate have) addressed.
 - b. This is just that final heads up to the President and a nice way to ensure you've covered all your bases prior to your final decision.
- 5. **AC Send Welcome & Announcement to PVE NW Board**

We want our BC's to feel welcome and integrated. This letter provides an official start and next steps in their new role as Block Captain.

 - a. Send out a welcome letter to new BC (see **Welcome Letter** template (Appendix 2, below)).
 - i. Copy (CC) the PVE NW President and Marcelle Herrera
 - b. Forward the welcome letter to Membership Chair requesting them to update the **NW Membership** file with a BC designation for the new BC.
- 6. **AC Send Welcome & Announcement to New BC's Neighbors** (*NEW in Revision 7*)

It's helpful for neighbors to get an official notice of their new BC. Consider including a photo of the new BC, if that is applicable.

 - a. Send out a welcome letter to new BC's Neighbors (see **Welcome Letter** template (Appendix 3, below)).
- 7. **AC Follow up/Support:**

Keeping a regular connection with our Block Captains will help them stay engaged with NW and with their neighbors. Mark your calendar to remind yourself to get in touch.

 - a. **In one week:** Contact BC to see if there are questions and if they have had a chance to select a few dates for a BC Meeting.
 - b. **Within 1 – 3 months:** Attend their first BC meeting, if possible.
 - c. **June:** Talk to BC about hosting a NNO Party
 - d. **October:** Invite BC to Annual Meeting
 - e. **December:** Consider sending out a Holiday Thank you
 - f. **January:** Consider sending out a New Year greeting and possible date for Area BC meeting. It's nice to have a meeting with all your BCs each year for appreciation and support. AC to ask Marcelle about scheduling an officer to visit.
 - g. The goal is for BC to have 1 – 2 meetings a year with their Blocks.
 - i. They can have an in-home meeting, a Street Meet or any other event that will bring the Block together for connection and education about neighborhood safety. Another option for a social gathering is to host an NNO Party.
 - ii. AC to work with Marcelle to coordinate dates if an officer is wanted for the event. Leverage your Community Lead Officer.

Appendix 1: BC Interview Guide

1. How long have you lived in the area? (other “get to know you” conversation)
2. What is motivating you to be a BC?
3. What questions do you have for me?
4. What ideas do you have for getting your neighborhood together?
5. How can I help you get started with your first Block Meeting?

Appendix 2: Welcome Letter Template:

Subject: Welcome Liz - New Valmonte Neighborhood Watch Block Captain!

Sent to: New Block Captain, NW President, Marcelle

CC: PVE NW Board including Membership Chair

Hello Liz,

I wanted to send you an official welcome as a PVE Neighborhood Watch Block Captain! I appreciate that you have stepped up to be a part of this important neighborhood connection organization.

On this e-mail I have included our PVE Neighborhood Watch President, Merlin David and our PVE Police Department Community Relations Officer, Marcelle Herrera as well as other members of our PVE Neighborhood Watch Board.

To get you started, I am providing you a link to our **PVE NW Block Captain Toolkit**: <https://app.box.com/s/mr2yo29pb43yj5txl5d3>. This is a folder where you will find checklists, templates and reference materials that will get you inspired on things that you might want to do for your Block.

Here are some good first steps:

For your Information:

- Check out the PVE Neighborhood Watch Website ([PVENW.org](https://pvenw.org))
- Review the items in the PVE NW Block Captain Toolkit
- Consider joining [AlertSouthBay.com](https://www.alertsouthbay.com) to be informed and connected with critical City updates
- If you join or are a member of Nextdoor, we like to keep a low and professional profile. We monitor posts about suspicious activities within our City and encourage neighbors to contact the PVE PD directly. Please review our website for recommended best behaviors on Nextdoor: (<https://www.pvenw.org/social-media-safety.html>)
- Contact Marcelle Herrera to schedule a meeting to say "Hello" if you have not already had a chance to meet (mherrera@pvestates.org)

For Your Block:

- Begin creating a roster of your Block's names and contact information
- Send an email or say hello to your neighbors and let them know you are their PVE Neighborhood Watch Block Captain (see template **New Block Captain Letter** in the **PVE NW Block Captain Toolkit**)
- Start preparing for a Neighborhood Watch meeting at your home (or the home of one of your neighbors or via Zoom). I will help you in coordinating date and topic. I will also coordinate with PVE PD to have a representative at the meeting.

Please contact me if you have questions.

Best of success!!

Karen Logan

PVE Neighborhood Watch Valmonte Area Coordinator

310.990.4326

Be aware, be prepared, be safe!!

If you see suspicious behavior, contact PVE Police Department (310-378-4211). Your call gives them a reason to check!

Appendix 3: Welcome Letter Template: For BC's Neighbors (awaiting template from Valerie)
(NEW in Revision 7)

Subject:

Appendix 4: Other Letter Templates:

Follow-up on an inquiry to be a Block Captain:

Suzie,

Sorry for the delay in getting back to you! I've had such a good response that I have had a hard time making sure all the loose ends are wrapped up!!

So glad to have you a part of our meeting last week. Thank you so much for your continued interest in being a Block Captain.

I have attached a **PVE Neighborhood Watch Block Captain** application. You can contact me if you have any further questions.

We like all of our Block Captains to be current on membership, since that support helps us to maintain costs for our non-profit organization. Membership dues support our communications, education and community support activities. Its only \$10 a year and helps to support our community outreach and administrative costs.

It looks like your membership was last paid on 5/5/15. We are making it easier to remember renewal dates including renewal reminders in our e-mail notices. Also, you can renew by mail or online.

To get information on membership renewal options: www.pvenw.org/membership

When you complete the application, please email it to me. I will follow-up to set up an interview call and I can answer your questions and get to know you a bit more, too.

Looking forward to talking with you again.

Karen Logan

PVE Neighborhood Watch Valmonte Area Coordinator

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Follow-up after a Block Captains' Meeting:

Hello Pat,

So happy you were able to make the Valmonte Block Captain Meeting. I appreciate your enthusiasm to be a part of the group and to serve your neighborhood.

I am following up with some of the items you had requested on the form you completed at the event:

- If you would like help in signing up for alertsouthbay.com, give me a call on my cell ([310.990.4326](tel:310.990.4326)) and we can walk through it together. If you want to give it a try, go to the website and look for the PVE Police department. I have selected to get both text and email alerts. It is very helpful to get the text alerts, since I've always got my phone with me. I have also signed up to get alerts from Redondo Beach, Torrance and LA County Sheriffs so I can get notifications for those cities that I frequent for driving and shopping.
- Please contact Marcelle (mherrera@pvestates.org) to coordinate a Home Safety Inspection. Let her know if this is just for you or if you will have a "block event". Also provide a few dates/times so she can coordinate with the PVE PD.
- **NW Block Meeting:**
 - When would you like to have this?
 - Do you want to get the handouts before the meeting or do you want them for your Block Meeting?
 - How many people do you need handouts for?

Let's talk on Sunday before 6pm or Monday. Please give me a call on my cell: [310.990.4326](tel:310.990.4326).

[Karen Logan](#)

2016 PVE Neighborhood Watch Valmonte Area Coordinator

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